



# County Council Budget Hearings 2025, Friday, September 5th, Afternoon Session

| Meeting Metadata | Details                                                                                               |
|------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Video Recording  | <a href="https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=tu_PPAwGhSM">https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=tu_PPAwGhSM</a> |
| Publication Date | 2025-09-06T08:12:46Z                                                                                  |
| Target Category  | delaware_county                                                                                       |

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## Municipal Meeting Report: Budget Hearings & County Council

### 1. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The meeting was called to order as a continuation of the municipal budget hearings.
- **Attendance:**
  - *Members Present:* Presiding officers, council members (including Bill, Eugene, Brad, Carrie, and others referenced in discussion), and staff (including Matt, Jessica, and Tanya from the auditor's office).
  - *Members Absent:* Not explicitly noted in the transcript.
  - *Presiding Officer:* The meeting was led by the presiding council chair / budget hearing lead.

### 2. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** None recorded in this segment of the transcript.
- **Approval of Minutes:** Not discussed.

### 3. Substantive Business & Board Action

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- **00:01:04 Departmental Budget Adjustments (Clerk, Auditor, Treasurer, Sheriff, Assessor, Courts, & Prosecutor)**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Matt and Jessica (Staff/Auditor's office).
  - **Deliberation Summary:** The board reviewed and executed various departmental budget reductions and adjustments primarily focusing on postage lines (line 322), salaries, FICA, and PERF. Adjustments included:
    - Clerk Department (Dept 125): Postage reduced by \$34,500; total adjustments noted at \$85,333.
    - Auditor Department (Dept 126): Postage reduced by \$4,600; discussion regarding stipends and a \$5,000 addition to the recording secretary's salary line.
    - Treasurer Department (Dept 127): Postage line 322 reduced by \$1,754.
    - Sheriff Department (Dept 129): Postage reduced by \$1,058; discussion regarding wiggle room in the commissioner and clerk budgets due to historically lower postage spending (\$100,000 under budget annually).
    - County Assessor Fund (Dept 134): Postage and freight reduced by \$1,564.
    - Courts (Dept 138): Postage and freight reduced by \$1,900; probation fund salary adjustments (\$228 decrease).
    - Prosecutor Title IV-D Family Support (Dept 237): Reduced by \$2,125.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:26:34 Liability Insurance and Operating Balances Presentation**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioner Stephen Brand and Mark Morrison.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Commissioner Brand discussed county liability insurance premiums, which currently cost \$1.3 million annually through March 2026. Discussion centered on renegotiating terms to align with the calendar year and structuring payments in July and January to match county settlement distributions. The board also debated maintaining an operating balance target of \$5 million versus \$6 million.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation; no formal roll call vote recorded.
- **00:35:58 Health Insurance Contributions and Clinic Utilization Review**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioner Stephen Brand, Matt, and Council Members.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** The board debated health insurance premium budgeting, employee contribution rates (discussing a shift to a true 90/10 or 85/15 split), and the financial impact of the county clinic. Staff noted clinic usage statistics (approx. 112 unique users over a rolling 12-month period against a \$531,000 annual clinic billing cost for 2024). Disagreement occurred over whether to adjust employee contribution rates before or after full renegotiations with McGriff.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational discussion; no formal vote taken.

- **01:03:44 Highway (MVH) and Cumulative Bridge Fund Adjustments & Salary Increases**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Carrie (Highway Department).
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Carrie proposed moving two Cumulative Bridge employees (the garage foreman and office assistant/payroll deputy) fully onto the Motor Vehicle Highway (MVH) fund (Fund 1176), totaling \$50,138 in salaries, to help fund a 6% pay increase for bridge employees without violating state board of accounts guidelines. The proposal also accounted for several eliminated headcount positions across highway and bridge departments.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.

#### 4. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

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*No general public comment or citizen forum period was held during this budget work session.*

#### 5. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

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- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
    - The council reviewed calendar availability for upcoming sessions.
    - It was determined that the next budget work session will be held on **Friday at 10:30 AM** in the same meeting room.
  - **Adjournment:** The meeting was placed into **Recess** at **01:53:31**.
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